



Finding one person meant scrolling.

So I built my own.

3,273 photos sitting in folders on my Mac, and no way to find every shot of one person.

macOS

On-device

Open source



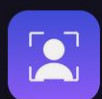
Facet

Free & open **source**

Every option wanted something.

Apple Photos only groups faces inside its own library — my folders were invisible to it. Google Photos wanted the upload. Immich and PhotoPrism wanted Docker, a database and a server to babysit.

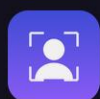
I just wanted to point something at a folder.



It finds every face and groups them into people.

Name someone once. Every new photo of them joins that group automatically.

No tagging. No sorting. No work.



Click a face. Get every photo of them.

Open any photo, tap the box around someone's face, and the whole library filters to that person. Combine two people to find shots of them together.

Or: everyone except this person.



Search by typing what's in the photo.

“beach sunset”. “birthday cake”. “dog in snow”. No tags, no albums, no filenames. It understands the picture itself.

Plain English

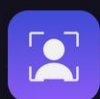
Instant



And it's on your phone. From anywhere.

Your Mac serves a small web app over your own private network. Family get their own logins and can browse and download — but never delete. That isn't a setting; the web side has no write endpoints at all.

Not one photo touches someone else's server.



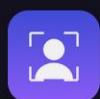
99.32%
on the LFW face
benchmark.

I tested the whole pipeline against the standard face-verification benchmark instead of guessing. ~250 images/sec on Apple Silicon — a 100,000-photo library indexes in minutes.

Vision

ArcFace

MobileCLIP





Try it.

Download the Mac app, or read every line of it.

github.com/VigneshDev16/facet

Part 3 of the series: building real solutions to problems I actually run into.

